ICONIC.

THE ONE-PAGE GUIDE
PRIVATE AI ON YOUR OWN COMPUTER

Own your intelligence. *Don't rent it.*

Everything a business owner needs to know before running AI on a computer in their own office.

01 · THE IDEA

One computer. Your files never leave.

The AI runs on a machine you own, inside your building. It reads your files, answers questions about your business and runs agents that do real work.

The models and the software are free and open. You pay for the computer, the power and the setup. There's no meter, so heavy use costs nothing extra.

02 · THE ONE NUMBER THAT MATTERS

Graphics memory decides what fits.

The AI has to fit inside the computer's graphics memory (VRAM). More memory means bigger, smarter models. Regular memory (RAM) doesn't make it faster.

Rule of thumb: about 1 GB per billion "parameters" at good quality, plus room to spare.

03 · WHAT SIZE COMPUTER DO YOU NEED?

GRAPHICS MEMORY	WHAT IT RUNS WELL	FEELS LIKE	GOOD FOR
24–48 GB · one strong graphics card	Fast mid-size models (Qwen 27–32B class)	QUICK instant replies	Q&A on your files, drafting, daily briefings, most agents
96 GB · one pro workstation card	32B models at full quality, 70B models at near-full quality	SHARP careful, detailed	Long documents, technical writing, harder reasoning
288 GB · three pro cards	The largest open models available	HEAVY big but not 3× faster	Only when you've outgrown one card. Most businesses never do

04 · QUALITY SETTINGS

Think of it like photo compression.

Full (FP16)	Best quality, biggest file
Half (FP8 · Q6)	Nearly identical, half the size. The sweet spot
Quarter (Q4)	Smallest and fastest. Fine for chat; avoid for work that must be exact

05 · FAST VS. SMART

Two kinds of model.

"Mixture" models use a small slice of themselves per word, so they're very fast. But the whole model still has to fit in memory.

"Dense" models use all of themselves every time. Slower, more predictable. Many setups run one of each.

06 · WHERE TO DRAW THE LINE

KEEP IT LOCAL
Client files, contracts, finances, anything confidential, and all the routine daily work. That's most of it.

CLOUD IS FINE
Public research and the very hardest one-off problems, with nothing private in the prompt. Pay per use, only when you need it.

Not sure where to start?
Book a free 30-minute private AI check.

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